country which is endowed with or develops good policy and institutions creates the right conditions for the human resources and capital to produce goods, services and assets to generate high growth and bring prosperity, and to institute fair redistribution for more equality. In such a country, the quality of life befits human dignity and rights, making nature and people live in harmony and happiness.

The Genesis of This Book

India had its national elections in May 2019 bringing economic policymaking activities to a virtual standstill.

Nripendra Misra, principal secretary to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, called some of us in late March to initiate preparations for a 100-day programme to be implemented after the elections. He also set in motion a process where different government departments would identify their priorities for inclusion in such a programme. This small group was to vet the development of the 100-day programme.

I, personally, do not set much value to such 100-day programmes as they usually tend to be built around unimplemented decisions of outgoing governments, address some short-term concerns and initiate a few new populist giveaways. As the discussions played out in April, the contents of the emerging programme convinced me that it would not address the fundamental policy issues the country India needed to work on.

I was instrumental in placing the national ambition of building a $10 trillion economy in Budget 2019–20 (interim). This goal fascinates me. It will transport India into an upper middle-income economy, make it prosperous, eliminate poverty from the face of the country and take care of concerns such as health, education and infrastructure. Budget 2019–20 (interim) had also articulated India’s intention to make the economy environmentally and socially sustainable. These imperatives required a drastic shift in economic policies.